# SECTION VII. RESIDENT SURVEY ANALYSIS

This section outlines results from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey. The analysis begins with an evaluation of current housing choice and needs, then pans outward toward community views, future housing choices, in-commuter choices, and opinions on housing policies and solutions. There were 1,146 total respondents in the Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

# SECTION VII. RESIDENT SURVEY ANALYSIS

## PRIMARY FINDINGS

### Current housing situation

- Affordability is a primary driver of housing choice, with 79% of respondents selecting their current home because of cost. Safety, bedrooms, and housing quality were secondary considerations.
- Precariously housed respondents, those living with friends or family but not on the lease, reported the highest rates of poor or fair housing conditions (38%), followed by single parents (35%), and mobile home occupants (25%).
- Nineteen percent of respondents with a disability or a household member with a disability reported that their home does not meet accessibility needs. The most commonly needed features were ramps and bathroom grab bars.

### Housing stability and displacement

- Sixteen percent of respondents experienced displacement in Larimer County within the past five years. Displacement rates were highest among renters, single parents with children, those living in subsidized housing, and precariously housed.
- Rental increases were the most common cause of displacement (35%). Respondents outside Loveland and Fort Collins were more likely to cite landlords selling rental units and also reported higher rates of displacement due to conflict with a partner and HOA fees.

### Future housing choice

- Forty-three percent of respondents wanted to move within the next three years. The most common reasons included needing a different-sized home or yard (53%), renting and wanting to own (46%), seeking more affordable housing (34%), wanting to move to a different neighborhood (23%), and other reasons (19%).
- Among renters, 77% cited inability to afford a down payment as a barrier to homeownership. Additional concerns included affording mortgage payments and fees (68%), inability to afford homes near work or preferred schools (45%), excessive debt (37%), and home insurance costs (26%).
- When asked about interest in a renter-to-homeownership support program, 69% of renters said they would be interested.

### Work and commute

- Thirty-two percent of commuters did not consider living where they work, most often because they did not feel it was important to live in the same community or they preferred a more rural environment.
- The remaining 68% did consider living where they work—of these respondents, 57% reported they could not find an affordable home to purchase in the same city they worked.

### Housing solutions and policy input

- Respondents rated "housing affordable to public service and retail workers" with the highest importance level (countywide, as well as in Fort Collins and Loveland). Respondents living elsewhere in Larimer County rated starter homes for first-time buyers as the most important.
- Residents broadly indicated that duplexes, townhomes, and accessory dwelling units (ADUs) were "appropriate in my neighborhood" but respondents were more hesitant about higher-density development in their neighborhoods.
- To increase affordability, 60% of respondents said they would support allowing duplexes or townhomes in their neighborhood, and 59% supported higher property taxes on high-value homes.

- Respondents identified resources that would help them feel more secure in their current housing, most commonly help finding an affordable home (27%), assistance with a down payment (19%), help obtaining a home loan (15%), funds for critical repairs (14%), and rental assistance (13%).

## METHODOLOGY

The Larimer County Resident Housing Survey was an online survey with a "snowball" sample, in which respondents were asked to share the survey amongst friends, family, and peers living in Larimer County. As such, the survey respondents do not represent a "random sample" of the regional population. A true random sample is a sample in which each individual in the population has an equal chance of being selected for the survey. The self-selected nature of the survey prevents the collection of a true random sample. Even so, the demographic profile of survey respondents is very similar to County residents overall (see survey demographics section).

When considering the experience of members of certain groups within jurisdictions, some sample sizes are too small (n<40 respondents) to express results quantitatively. In these cases, we describe the survey findings as representative of those who responded to the survey, but that the magnitude of the estimate may vary significantly in the overall population (i.e., large margin of error). Survey data from small samples are suggestive of an experience or preference, rather than conclusive.

**Promotion.** The survey was promoted in English and Spanish using:

- Social media posts on City and County accounts on Nextdoor, Facebook, Instagram, and X (mid-September to mid-November);
- Notification of resident survey to local media outlets;
- Pop-up advertisements for visitors of City and County websites;
- Landing page on Larimer County's website advertising the resident survey, community events, and updates on the HNA;
- Flyers in high-visibility areas throughout Larimer County, including libraries, recreation centers, senior centers, and within subsidized housing complexes;
- Advertisements within newsletters for various social service providers and community organizations, including local housing authorities; and
- Promotion during other engagement events, including community meetings held in Fort Collins and Loveland, resident focus groups, and stakeholder focus groups.

**Geographic note.** Throughout this section, survey data is broken down by the jurisdiction in which the respondent lives. Residents within the "Elsewhere in Larimer County" category represent those who selected Berthoud, Estes Park, Laporte, Timnath, Wellington, Windsor, Unincorporated Larimer County, or somewhere else in Larimer County. People who work in Larimer County but do not live in Larimer County are included in the "Work and Commutes" section that seeks to understand in-commuter choices, but not included in Larimer County total.

### Explanation of terms:

- "Precariously housed" includes residents who are currently homeless, living in transitional or temporary/emergency housing, or are staying with friends or family temporarily and not on the lease or property title.
- "Subsidized housing" refers to a respondent whose household's housing costs are subsidized by a housing voucher (e.g., Section 8/Housing Choice Voucher), public housing, LIHTC, project-based Section 8, deed-restricted ownership products, and any other place-based housing subsidies.

**Figure VII-1.**
**Example Website and Social Media Promotion**

larimercounty

Liked by [redacted] and **others**

**larimercounty** Finding a good place to live is different these days. What are your needs for housing? 🏠 Tell us! #LarimerCounty, #FortCollins, and #Loveland have joined together on a regional housing assessment and need your help!
Take our easy survey 📋 and tell us what you think! Find it here: https://www.research.net/r/

**City of Loveland, Colorado - Government**
Nov 18 •

Time is running out! 🏡 The City of Loveland is working with Larimer County and the City of Fort Collins on a Regional Housing Needs Assessment designed to gather community feedback on housing types, needs, and challenges across all income levels and life stages.

🔗 Access the survey before it closes on Nov. 21 at: **www.research.net/r/LarimerCoHousingSurvey25**

If you have problems with the survey, please call 970-880-1415 ext.100 for support, or email hello@rootpolicy.com to request a document that can be completed and returned.

**2025 Regional Housing Needs Assessment—Get Involved!**

- Take the survey!
- Come to an open house community meeting!
- What is the housing Needs Assessment?
- Stay connected

**Take the Survey!**
This 15-minute survey is for anyone who lives or works anywhere in Larimer County. The survey is part of a partnership between the County, Loveland, and Fort Collins to better understand regional housing issues and identify solutions to housing challenges. If you complete the survey by Friday, Nov. 21st, you can **enter a drawing for a $100 Visa gift card.** The survey asks about your housing situation, your housing preferences, and your opinions on addressing housing needs. It is not associated with any political party or election.

English: www.research.net/r/LarimerCoHousingSurvey25

en español: www.research.net/r/LarimerCoHousingSurvey25?lang=es

**Upcoming Community Meetings**
Housing affects us all — neighbors, family, friends. Larimer County/ Fort Collins/ Loveland is studying local housing needs and we want to hear from you! Take part in upcoming open houses to share your thoughts on housing needs and solutions:

- Fort Collins: October 9th, 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. at the Old Town Library (201 Peterson Street, Fort Collins, 80524)
- Loveland: October 11th,11:30 a.m. to 1:30 p.m. at the Loveland Public Library (300 Adams Avenue, Loveland, 80537)

## SURVEY DEMOGRAPHICS

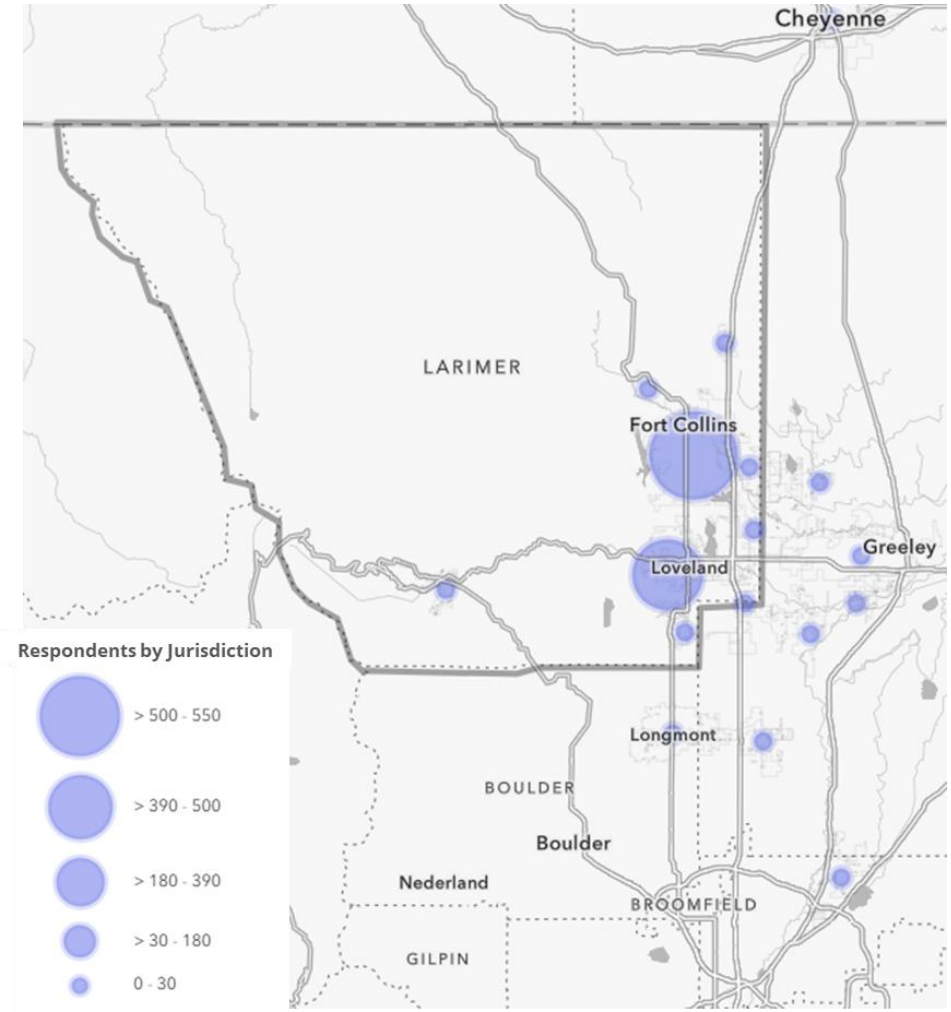
There were 1,146 total respondents to the Larimer County Resident Housing Survey. Almost half (47%) of respondents lived in Fort Collins—proportional to the share of the county's population living in Fort Collins—and 42% lived in Loveland—a proportion higher than its share of the county population. Nine percent of survey respondents lived elsewhere in Larimer County and 2% were in-commuters to Larimer County. Figure VII-2 maps respondents by the jurisdiction in which they live.

The demographic profile of survey respondents is similar to data for the county overall (See Section I for comparable demographic data):

- 63% of respondents were homeowners (compared to a 64% homeownership rate in Larimer County).
- 76% respondents were non-Hispanic White (the same as the proportion of the county population that identifies as non-Hispanic white). Another 8% of respondents identified as Hispanic, 4% who were mixed or multiracial, and 12% who identified as another race not listed.
- Among survey respondents, 22% of reported incomes below $50,000, 32% $50,000 to $100,000, 22% $100,000 to $150,000 and 25% reported incomes over $150,000. According to ACS data, in Larimer County, the actual proportions are 27%, 29%, 20%, and 25%--very close to survey respondent incomes.

Figure VII-3 displays the demographics of respondents by jurisdiction.

**Figure VII-2.**
**Map of Respondents by Jurisdiction**




Note: n = 1,146.; Does not place responses from unspecified unincorporated Larimer County. Responses outside Larimer County were designated as in-commuters

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Figure VII-3. Resident Survey Sample Sizes by Jurisdiction and Selected Characteristics**

| | All Respondents | | Fort Collins | | Loveland | | Elsewhere in Larimer County | | In-Commuters | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Num. | Pct. | Num. | Pct. | Num. | Pct. | Num. | Pct. | Num. | Pct. |
| **Total Responses** | **1,146** | **100%** | **543** | **47%** | **484** | **42%** | **100** | **9%** | **19** | **2%** |
| **Tenure** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Homeowner** | 724 | 63% | 302 | 56% | 338 | 70% | 72 | 72% | 12 | 63% |
| **Renter** | 346 | 30% | 212 | 39% | 111 | 23% | 18 | 18% | 5 | 26% |
| **Precariously Housed** | 55 | 5% | 21 | 4% | 24 | 5% | 8 | 8% | 2 | 11% |
| **Mobile Home Occupant** | 39 | 3% | 25 | 5% | 10 | 2% | 4 | 4% | 0 | 0% |
| **Subsidized Housing** | 63 | 5% | 36 | 7% | 19 | 4% | 7 | 7% | 1 | 5% |
| **Race and Ethnicity** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Non-Hispanic White** | 639 | 76% | 323 | 79% | 261 | 75% | 47 | 68% | 8 | 57% |
| **Hispanic** | 64 | 8% | 26 | 6% | 24 | 7% | 8 | 12% | 6 | 43% |
| **Mixed / Multiracial** | 37 | 4% | 17 | 4% | 17 | 5% | 3 | 4% | 0 | 0% |
| **Other** | 102 | 12% | 44 | 11% | 47 | 13% | 11 | 16% | 0 | 0% |
| **Household Income** | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Less than $50,000** | 177 | 22% | 91 | 23% | 72 | 21% | 11 | 16% | 3 | 20% |
| **$50,000 to $74,999** | 132 | 16% | 61 | 15% | 61 | 18% | 8 | 12% | 2 | 13% |
| **$75,000 to $99,999** | 129 | 16% | 56 | 14% | 59 | 18% | 13 | 19% | 1 | 7% |
| **$100,000 to $149,999** | 177 | 22% | 85 | 21% | 73 | 22% | 15 | 22% | 4 | 27% |
| **Over $150,000** | 201 | 25% | 105 | 26% | 71 | 21% | 20 | 30% | 5 | 33% |

Note:

n = 1,146. Numbers do not aggregate either due to multiple response or because respondents did not choose to provide a response to all demographic and socioeconomic questions. In-commuters reside outside of Larimer County.

Source:

Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

## CURRENT HOUSING SITUATION

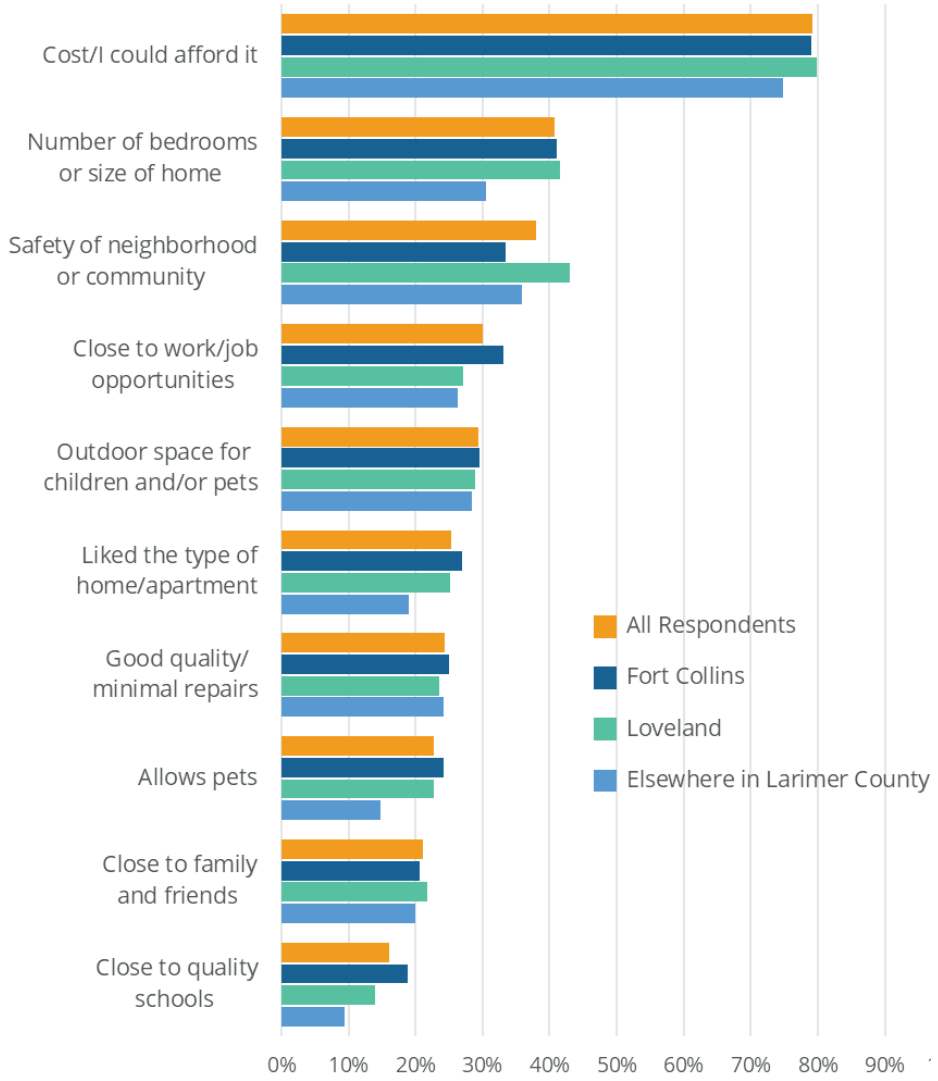
**Housing choice.** The survey began with questions to assess reasons why respondents are in their current home or housing situation. Cost and affordability were the most common answers across jurisdictions, followed by the number of bedrooms and size of home, safety of neighborhood and community, proximity to work or job opportunities, and outdoor space for children and pets.

As shown in Figure VII-4, selection rates by jurisdiction are mostly consistent, though Loveland had a slightly higher rate of respondents who selected "safety of neighborhood and community" as a reason for choosing their current home.

Reasons for choosing a home varied by tenure and household type, as shown in Figure VII-5 on the following page. Though all groups rated cost/affordability highest, other variations included:

- Mobile home occupants, precariously housed respondents, and respondents in subsidized housing were more likely than other groups to say needing a place quickly was a factor in choosing their current home.
- Homeowners were more likely than other tenure groups (renters, mobile home occupants, and precariously housed) to say they prioritized safety of the neighborhood and community.
- Respondents with children were more likely than other household groups to select proximity to quality schools.
- Compared to couples with children, single parents were more likely to factor in their home's proximity to work.

**Figure VII-4.**
**Factors in Choosing Current Home, by Jurisdiction**




Note: n = 1,118

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Figure VII-5.**
**Top 5 Factors in Choosing Current Home or Apartment, Tenure and Household Type**

| Homeowner | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 77% |
| 2 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 41% |
| 3 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 40% |
| 4 | Outdoor space for children/ pets | 33% |
| 5 | Good quality/ minimal repairs | 28% |

| Renter | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 84% |
| 2 | Allows pets | 43% |
| 3 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 43% |
| 4 | Close to work/job opportunities | 35% |
| 5 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 34% |

| Mobile Home Occupant | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 72% |
| 2 | Close to family and friends | 31% |
| 3 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 22% |
| 4 | Allows pets | 22% |
| 5 | Needed a place to live quickly | 22% |

| Precariously Housed | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 74% |
| 2 | Close to family and friends | 40% |
| 3 | Needed a place to live quickly | 36% |
| 4 | Allows pets | 32% |
| 5 | Close to work/job opportunities | 30% |

| Subsidized Housing | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 76% |
| 2 | Allows pets | 39% |
| 3 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 34% |
| 4 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 32% |
| 5 | Needed a place to live quickly | 31% |

| Couple with Children | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 83% |
| 2 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 54% |
| 3 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 49% |
| 4 | Outdoor space for children/ pets | 46% |
| 5 | Close to quality schools | 35% |

| Single Parent | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 85% |
| 2 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 53% |
| 3 | Close to quality schools | 50% |
| 4 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 48% |
| 5 | Close to work/job opportunities | 43% |

| Older Adult Household | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 75% |
| 2 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 37% |
| 3 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 36% |
| 4 | Liked the type of home/apartment | 27% |
| 5 | Close to family and friends | 24% |

| Disability | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cost/I could afford it | 77% |
| 2 | Number of bedrooms/size of home | 40% |
| 3 | Safety of neighborhood/community | 35% |
| 4 | Allows pets | 34% |
| 5 | Outdoor space for children/ pets | 29% |

Note: n = 1,118.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

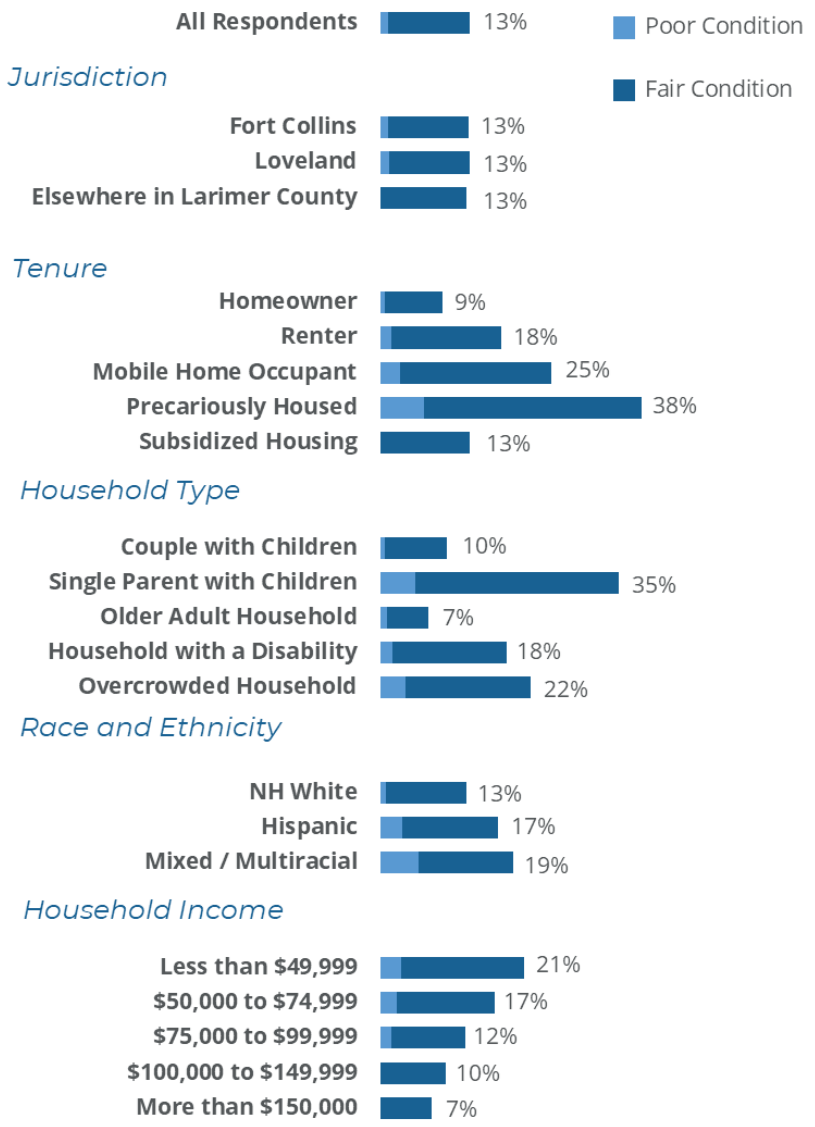
**Housing condition.** Responses to current housing choice showed that respondents across demographic groups prioritized cost factors more than quality or condition. The survey also asked respondents to evaluate their housing conditions to explore if quality concerns and repair needs are present. Figure VII-6 displays the combined percentage of respondents who rated their home in poor condition (defined as a home or apartment with major problems that are not healthy or safe) and in fair condition (defined as a home or apartment needs a lot of work):

- Precariously housed residents, mostly made up of those living with friends or family but not on the lease, reported the highest rate of poor or fair housing conditions (38%). Single parents had the next highest rate at 35%.
- Renters reported poor or fair housing conditions at double the rate of homeowners (18% compared to 9%). Mobile home occupants and precariously housed residents reported the highest rates of poor housing conditions out of all tenure groups; and
- Not surprisingly, condition ratings improved as income increased.

Half (50%) of respondents who needed improvements selected cosmetic upgrades as their most needed repair, followed by energy efficiency improvements (35%), weatherization (29%), window replacement (28%), and landscaping (27%). Figure VII-7 (on the next page) shows needed repairs by Jurisdiction, tenure, and income.

Forty-two percent of respondents who needed repairs said they have not been completed because they cannot afford to complete them. Thirty-nine percent of single parents and 21% of Hispanic residents in need of repairs reported they were worried that a repair request would lead to a rent increase or eviction—the highest of all demographic groups.

**Figure VII-6. Poor and Fair Housing Condition Ratings**




Note: n = 1,116.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Figure VII-7. Top Five Needed Repairs, by Jurisdiction, Tenure and Household Income**

| All Respondents | | Fort Collins | | Loveland | | Elsewhere in Larimer County | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 Cosmetic improvements | 50% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 49% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 53% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 45% |
| 2 Energy efficiency | 35% | 2 Energy efficiency | 39% | 2 Energy efficiency | 34% | 2 Windows | 33% |
| 3 Weatherization | 29% | 3 Windows | 31% | 3 Weatherization | 29% | 3 Weatherization | 26% |
| 4 Windows | 28% | 4 Weatherization | 30% | 4 Landscaping | 26% | 4 Landscaping | 26% |
| 5 Landscaping | 27% | 5 Landscaping | 28% | 5 Windows | 24% | 5 Energy efficiency | 22% |

| Homeowner | | Renter | | Mobile Home Occupant | | Precariously Housed | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 Cosmetic improvements | 53% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 47% | 1 Windows | 42% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 53% |
| 2 Energy efficiency | 34% | 2 Energy efficiency | 38% | 2 Cosmetic improvements | 42% | 2 Interior walls or ceilings | 45% |
| 3 Landscaping | 33% | 3 Weatherization | 36% | 3 Cooling system | 35% | 3 Energy efficiency | 34% |
| 4 Windows | 31% | 4 Interior walls/ceilings | 29% | 4 Plumbing | 31% | 4 Windows | 32% |
| 5 Weatherization | 26% | 5 Cooling system | 24% | 5 Energy efficiency | 31% | 5 Weatherization | 24% |

| Income Less than $50,000 | | $50,000 to $74,999 | | $75,000 to $99,999 | | $100,000 to $149,999 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 Energy efficiency | 35% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 46% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 62% | 1 Cosmetic improvements | 65% |
| 2 Cosmetic improvements | 35% | 2 Energy efficiency | 41% | 2 Landscaping | 36% | 2 Energy efficiency | 31% |
| 3 Windows | 33% | 3 Weatherization | 36% | 3 Energy efficiency | 36% | 3 Windows | 29% |
| 4 Weatherization | 31% | 4 Plumbing | 30% | 4 Weatherization | 30% | 4 Landscaping | 27% |
| 5 Interior walls or ceilings | 24% | 5 Landscaping | 27% | 5 Windows | 25% | 5 Weatherization | 27% |

Note: n = 651.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Accessibility Needs.** In addition to housing conditions, an important element to housing stability for residents with disabilities is accessibility/adaptability of their home. Nineteen percent of respondents who reported they or someone in their household had a disability reported that their home does *not meet* their accessibility needs.

Households living "elsewhere in Larimer County" were the least likely to have homes meeting accessibility needs. By tenure, mobile home occupants and precariously housed residents reported their home did not meet accessibility needs at the highest rates (35% and 36%, respectively).

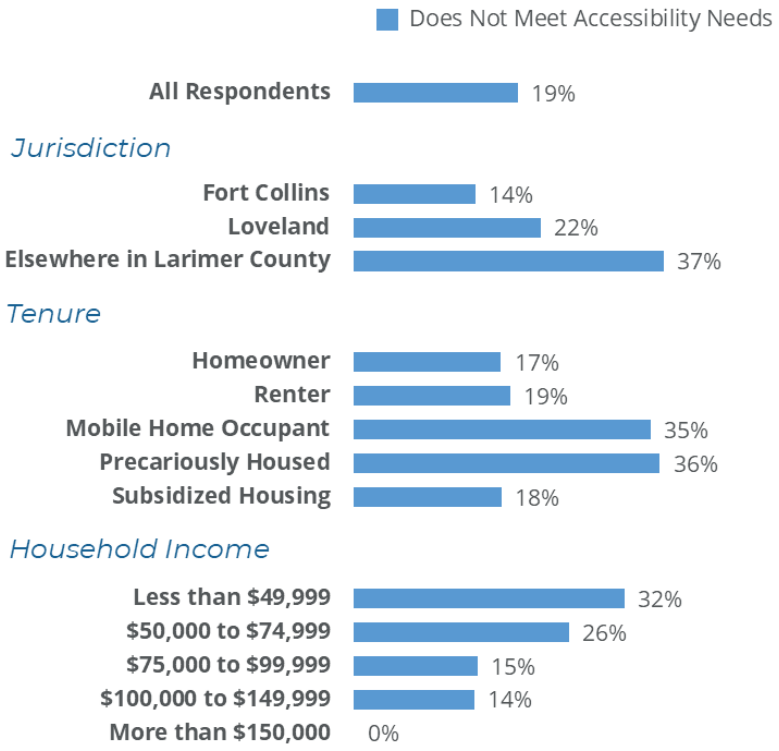
Forty-five percent of all respondents whose home did not meet accessibility needs reported the need for ramps, followed by grab bars in the bathroom (41%), wider doorways (33%), stair lifts (24%), and lower kitchen and bathroom counters (22%). The top needs for homeowners, renters, and mobile home occupants were ramps and grab bars in the bathroom. Half (50%) of precariously housed residents whose current residence did not meet accessibility needs reported that their service or emotional support animal was not allowed in the place they were currently staying in.

Other open-ended answers included:

- "I would benefit from a place without stairs." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "Step in shower." – *Homeowner in Loveland*
- "Handrails by front stairs." – *Homeowner in Loveland*
- "Modified shower and bottom floor apartment." – *Renter elsewhere in Larimer County*

Almost a quarter (23%) of all respondents with a disability reported that it was not likely at all that they would find a home in their community that met accessibility needs if they had to move and 46% said they are not able to afford housing with accessibility features that they need. Additionally, 35% worried about eviction or a rent increase if they requested an accommodation from their landlord.

**Figure VII-8.**
**Does Your Home Meet Accessibility Needs?**



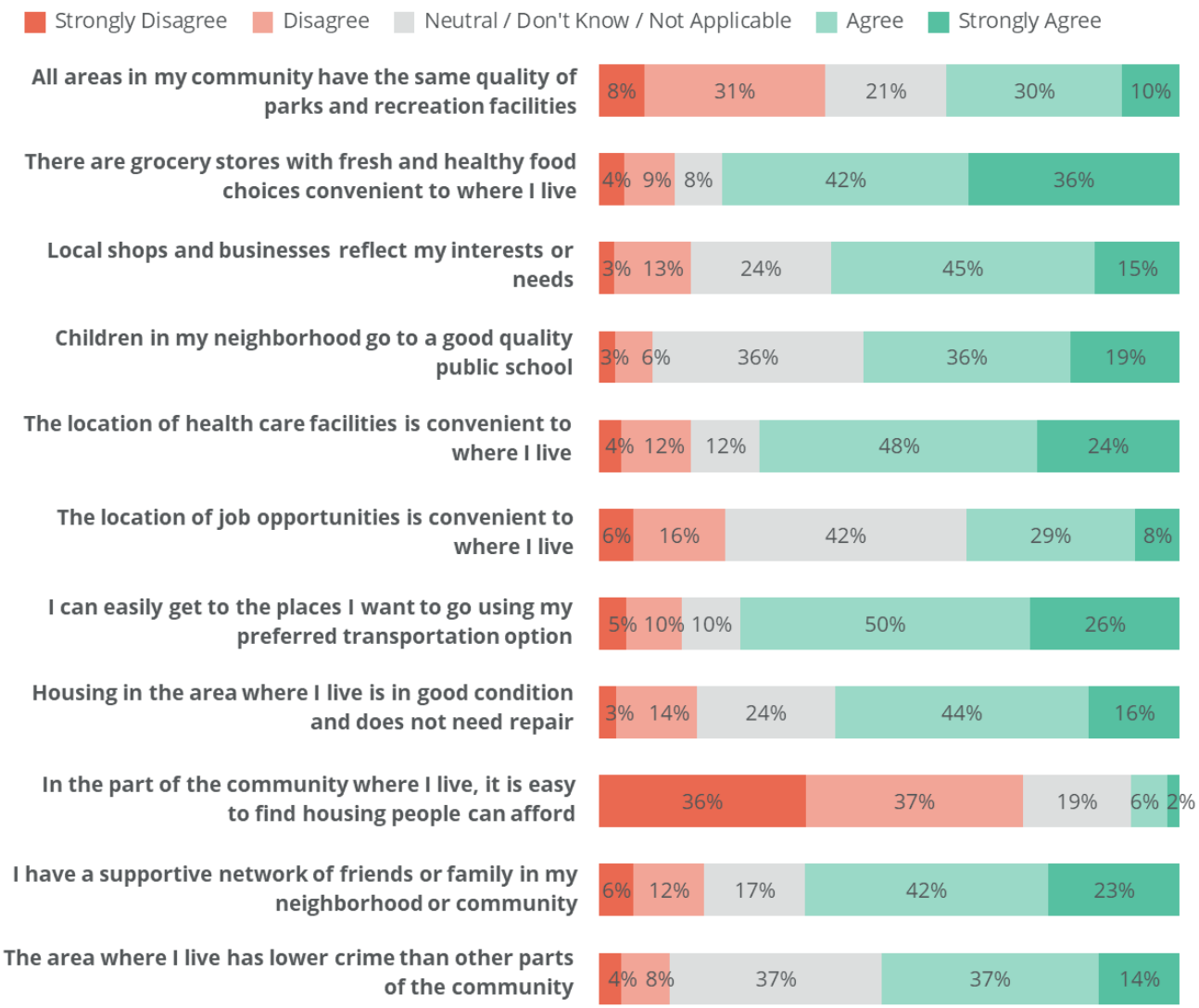

Note: n = 309; Reflects respondents who indicated someone in their household has a disability.
Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Neighborhood and Community.** Sixty-eight percent of respondents agreed or strongly agreed that they feel welcome in all neighborhoods in their community, reflecting a strong sense of community ties and comfortability for residents across Larimer County.

There was variation between demographic groups, however: Single parents, respondents with a disability, Hispanic, and Mixed or Multiracial respondents had the highest rates of respondents who did not feel welcome in all neighborhoods of their community.

Figure VII-9 shows level of agreement on specific community and neighborhood quality items. Respondents agreed the most strongly that there are grocery stores close to where they live, that it is easy to get places using preferred transportation methods, locations of health care facilities are convenient, and that they have a supportive network of family and friends within their neighborhood. Respondents disagreed the most strongly that people can find housing they can afford in the community they live in.

**Figure VII-9.**
**Level of Agreement on Community Items, All Respondents**




Note: n = 881.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

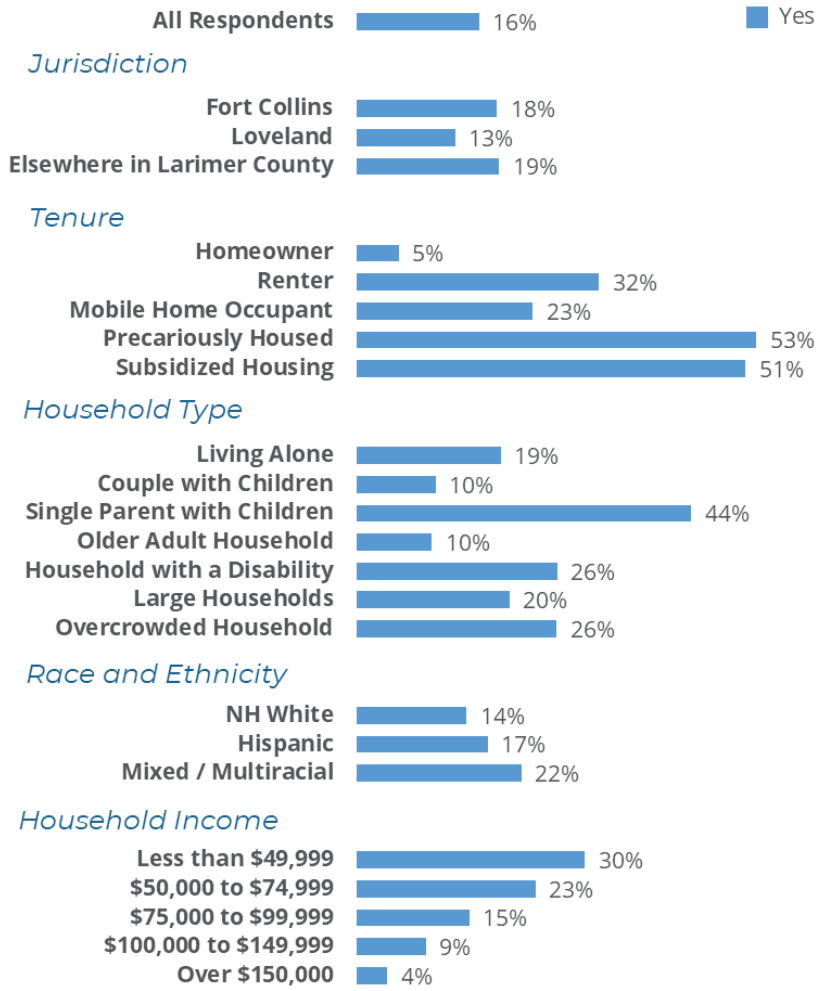
## HOUSING STABILITY AND DISPLACEMENT

Sixteen percent of respondents reported they have experienced displacement, defined as having to move in the past five years when they did not want to. As shown in Figure VII-10, precariously housed respondents, respondents who now live in subsidized housing, and single parents had the highest rate of reported displacement from their previous housing situation. Hispanic and Multiracial respondents had higher displacement rates than non-Hispanic White respondents.

The top reason for displacement reported by respondents was rent increasing more than they could afford, followed by job loss or reduced hours that resulted in reduced wages (see Figure VII-11 on the next page). Open-ended responses from the "other" category included the following stories:

- "Rent increases were twice per year over the course of nine years under the same lease." – *Precariously Housed in Loveland*
- "Property manager cycled random roommates in and out without notification. One roommate made home feel unsafe." –*Fort Collins renter*
- "The landlord increased rent by 20% without warning despite us having been stellar tenants." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "Medical injury with loss of income." – *Renter in Loveland*
- "Property taxes increased too much. Landlord only increase rent to cover new property tax rate increase… He was going to make $1-200 per year more on a ~20% rent increase." –*Loveland resident*
- "Me mudé como 6 meses por que éramos muchos en la casa y no cabíamos, después me regresé otra vez por que vendieron la traila donde rentaba / I moved for about 6 months because there were many of us in the house and we didn't fit, then I came back again because they sold the trailer where I rented." – *Mobile Home Occupant in Fort Collins*

**Figure VII-10. In the past 5 years, have you had to move out of a home when you did not want to?**




Note: n = 931.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Figure VII-11. Top Reasons for Displacement (among respondents experiencing displacement)**

| All Respondents | | | Fort Collins | | | Loveland | | | Elsewhere in Larimer County | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rent increased more than I could pay | 35% | 1 | Rent increased more than I could pay | 33% | 1 | Rent increased more than I could pay | 42% | 1 | Job loss, reduced hours or wages | 38% |
| 2 | Job loss, reduced hours or wages | 34% | 2 | Job loss, reduced hours or wages | 30% | 2 | Job loss, reduced hours or wages | 40% | 2 | Landlord sold my rental unit or complex | 38% |
| 3 | Other | 20% | 3 | Other | 20% | 3 | Other | 25% | 3 | Rent increased more than I could pay | 23% |
| 4 | Landlord sold my rental unit or complex | 20% | 4 | Change in household size | 17% | 4 | Landlord sold my rental unit or complex | 21% | 4 | Conflict with partner or roommate | 23% |
| 5 | Change in household size | 18% | 5 | Landlord sold my rental unit or complex | 16% | 5 | Change in household size | 19% | 5 | HOA fees increased more than I could pay | 15% |

Note: n = 147.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Impacts of displacement.** Among Larimer County respondents who experienced displacement:

- 72% said it took more than one month to find a new place to live;
- Over half (55%) experienced higher rent or housing costs after displacement;
- One-third (33%) reported longer commutes to work or school; and
- 30% said that the quality of their apartment or home was worse than the home from which they were displaced.

The most common reason for displacement is rising rents and yet over half end up in new housing situations with higher rents—suggesting that displacement can quickly become a recurring experience.

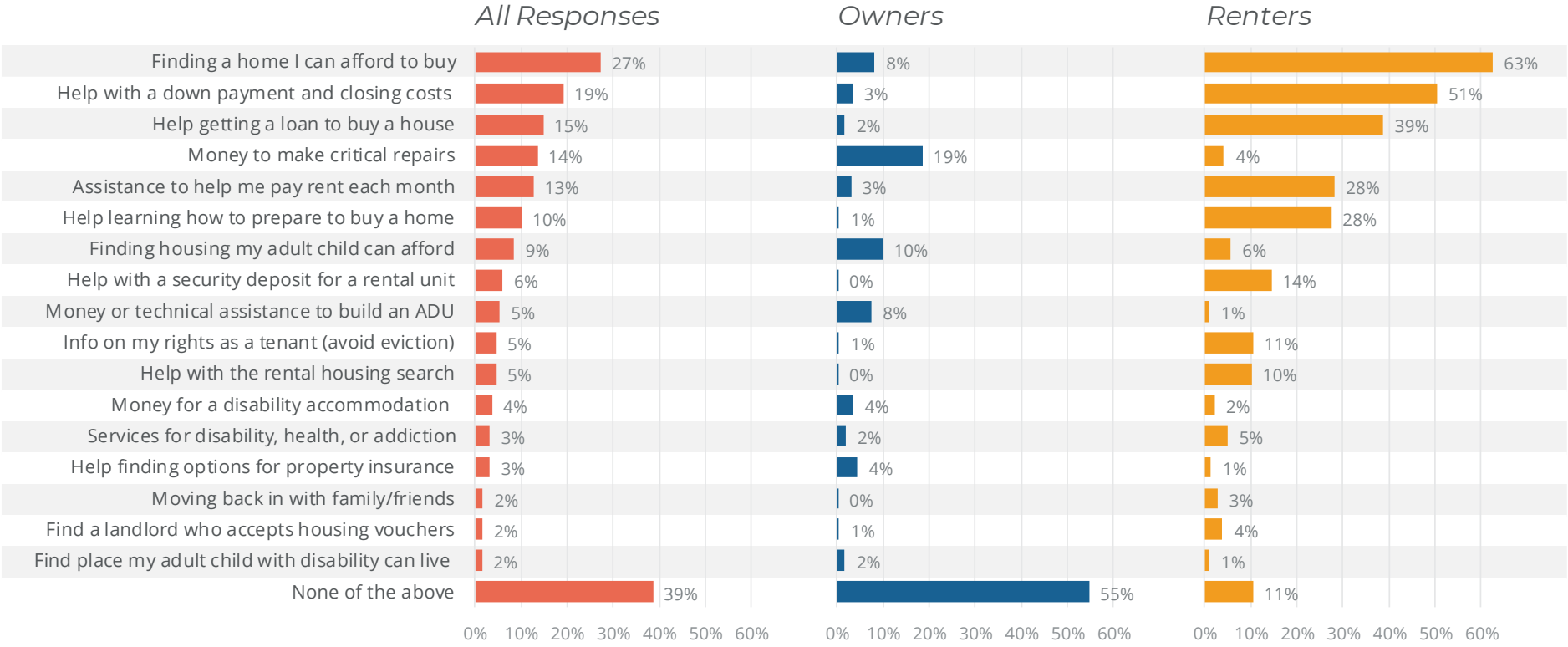
**Housing search barriers.** The survey asked respondents to select potential barriers they have experienced when looking for housing in Larimer County over the past five years. The most common barrier was unreturned calls from landlords or agents (18%). When such barriers are disproportionately experienced by protected class groups, they can be an indicator of potentially discriminatory behaviors occurring in the marketplace.

Among survey respondents, single parents and overcrowded households reported the highest rates of landlords not returning calls and landlords prohibiting service or emotional support animals. Hispanic and Mixed or Multiracial respondents were more likely than non-Hispanic white respondents to report that they were told a unit was available over the phone, but then told it was not available when they showed up in person.

**Housing security.** When asked what would help respondents feel more secure in their current housing situation, the most common responses were finding an affordable home to buy; help with a down payment; help getting a home loan; money to make critical repairs; and rental assistance. However, responses varied by tenure and household characteristic (and, to a lesser extent, by jurisdiction). See Figures VII-12 through VII-14.

As shown in Figure VII-12, homeowners were much more likely to say they didn't need anything to feel more secure (55%) than renters (11%). Renters were most likely to want support buying a home (63% finding an affordable home to buy; 51% help with down payment) but 28% also said rental assistance would help them feel more secure. Owners were most likely to say "money to make critical repairs" and "finding housing my adult child can afford."

**Figure VII-12.**
**What do you feel you need to be more secure in your housing situation? Select the three most important items.** (By Tenure)




Note: n = 892.

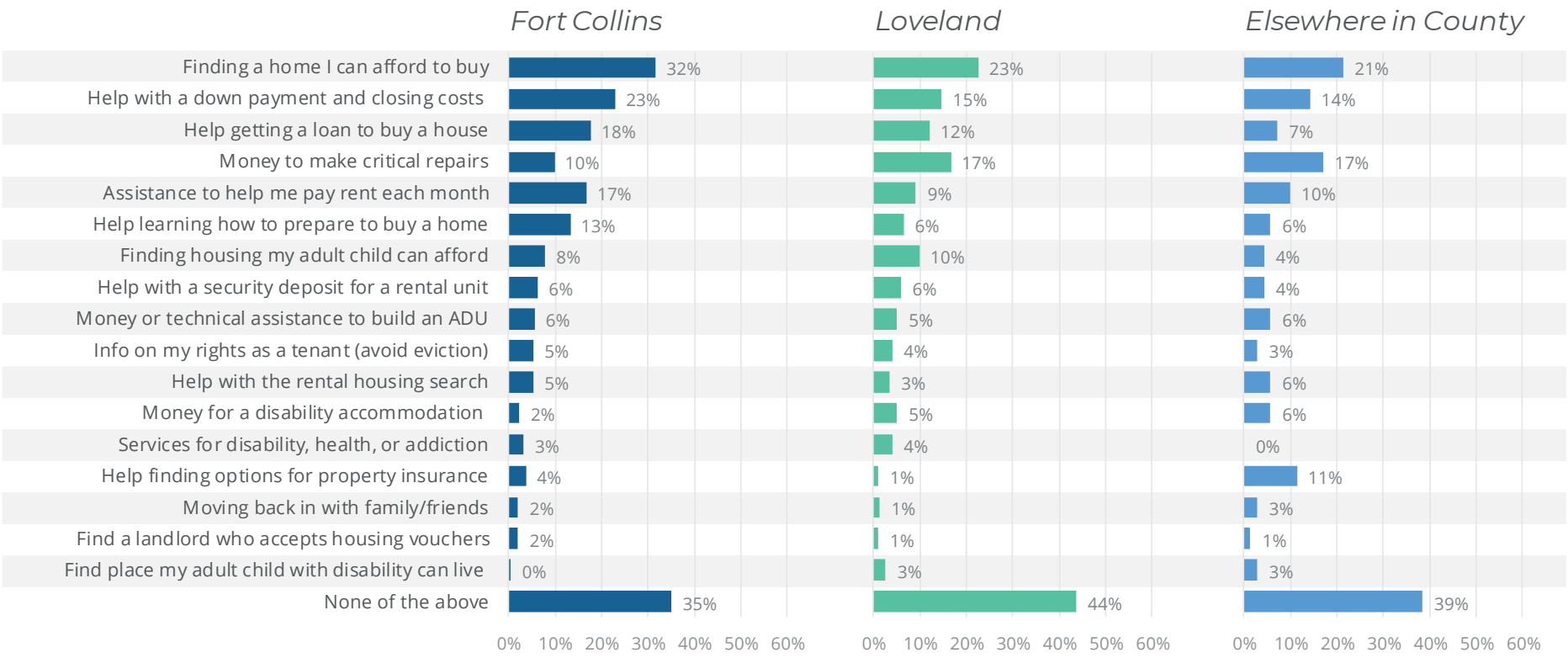
Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

Responses by jurisdiction were similar to the overall survey results, with finding an affordable home to buy the most common response in Fort Collins, Loveland, and Elsewhere in the County. The second most common response in Loveland and Elsewhere in the County was money to make critical repairs (likely partially due to the higher homeownership rates in these communities).

Figure VII-14 on the following page shows responses by household characteristic. Help with rent and finding an affordable home to buy were the top responses among mobile home occupants, precariously housed individuals, and those living in subsidized housing.

Large households and older adult households were more likely than other groups to prioritize housing for their adult child.

**Figure VII-13.**
**What do you feel you need to be more secure in your housing situation? Select the three most important items.** (By Place)




Note: n = 892.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Figure VII-14.**
**What do you feel you need to be more secure in your housing situation? Select the three most important items.**
(By Household Characteristic)

| | All Respondents | Mobile Home Occupant | Precariously Housed | Subsidized Housing | HHs with Children | Older Adults (65+) | HH with a Disability | Large Households |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Total respondents** | **892** | 25 | 34 | 47 | 197 | 228 | 246 | 63 |
| **Finding a home I can afford to buy** | **27%** | 24% | 53% | 47% | 31% | 12% | 33% | 27% |
| **Help with a down payment and closing costs** | **19%** | 16% | 26% | 43% | 25% | 7% | 24% | 19% |
| **Help getting a loan to buy a house** | **15%** | 12% | 29% | 36% | 17% | 5% | 21% | 16% |
| **Money to make critical repairs** | **14%** | 20% | 15% | 4% | 17% | 8% | 15% | 14% |
| **Assistance to help me pay rent each month** | **13%** | 28% | 38% | 34% | 17% | 7% | 23% | 16% |
| **Help learning how to prepare to buy a home** | **10%** | 0% | 24% | 17% | 10% | 2% | 12% | 11% |
| **Finding housing my adult child can afford** | **9%** | 8% | 9% | 15% | 11% | 10% | 14% | 22% |
| **Help with a security deposit for a rental unit** | **6%** | 4% | 26% | 19% | 9% | 4% | 14% | 11% |
| **Money or technical assistance to build an ADU** | **5%** | 0% | 6% | 6% | 7% | 7% | 7% | 11% |
| **Info on my rights as a tenant (avoid eviction)** | **5%** | 8% | 21% | 15% | 3% | 4% | 10% | 8% |
| **Help with the rental housing search** | **5%** | 4% | 24% | 15% | 6% | 2% | 9% | 8% |
| **Money for a disability accommodation** | **4%** | 12% | 12% | 15% | 3% | 8% | 9% | 8% |
| **Services for disability, health, or addiction** | **3%** | 0% | 12% | 17% | 2% | 4% | 10% | 0% |
| **Help finding options for property insurance** | **3%** | 4% | 0% | 2% | 5% | 2% | 2% | 5% |
| **Moving back in with family/friends** | **2%** | 0% | 18% | 0% | 1% | 2% | 4% | 3% |
| **Find a landlord who accepts housing vouchers** | **2%** | 12% | 3% | 17% | 2% | 1% | 4% | 0% |
| **Find place my adult child with disability can live** | **2%** | 4% | 3% | 0% | 1% | 4% | 4% | 5% |
| **None of the above** | **39%** | 12% | 12% | 11% | 33% | 55% | 23% | 27% |

Note: n = 892.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

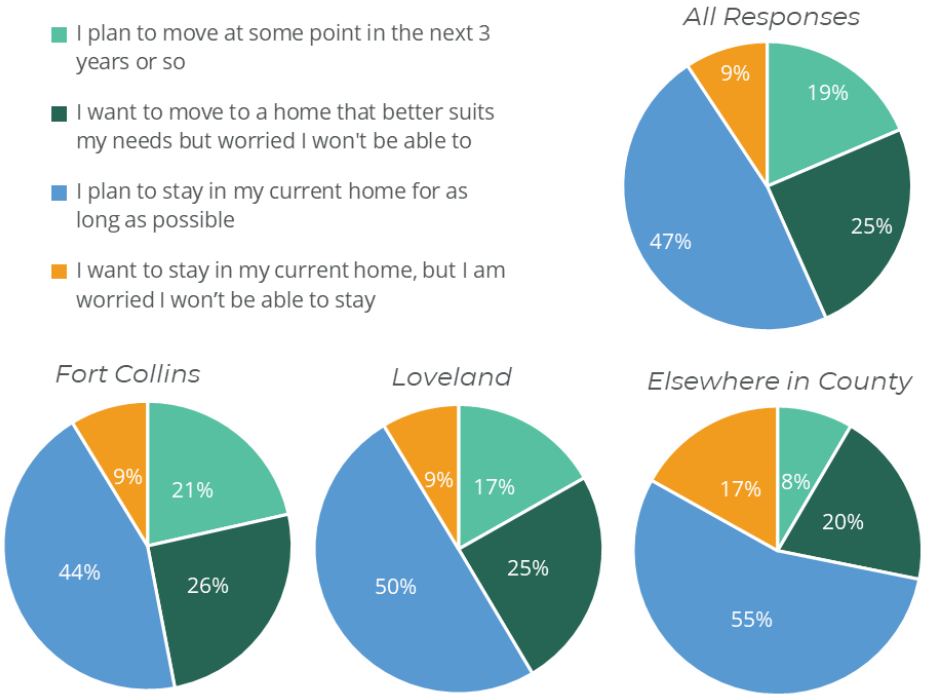
Select open-ended responses to improve housing security included:

- "I will need a more accessible home soon. Too many steps, but can't afford a ramp." – *Renter in Loveland*
- "Can't afford medical insurance because rent is too high." – *Renter in Loveland*
- "I am stably housed and prioritize rent every month. I have never been late on a payment. However, I do live pay check to pay check. With the cost of living rising, it is very challenging to set aside money for emergency savings. If an emergency were to come up, I would not be in a good spot. If I lost my current employment, I would definitely be at risk of homelessness." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "Help figuring out how to be able to move to a single level unit on the same property." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "Much more affordable senior housing. Currently everything has a minimum 2 year waiting list." – *Mobile home occupant in Fort Collins*
- "I am on Social Security and my lot rent increases every year. I will have move at some point because it will be unaffordable even though I own my home." – *Mobile home occupant in Fort Collins*
- "Finding an actual house that accepts a housing voucher and modifications" – *Resident living Elsewhere in Larimer County*

## FUTURE HOUSING CHOICE

Nearly half of survey respondents (47%) plan to stay in their current home as long as possible. That proportion is even higher in Loveland (50%) and Elsewhere in the County (55%). Forty-three percent of survey respondents indicated they want to move in the next three years—that group is split between people who "plan" to move and those who would like to move but are worried they won't be able to.

**Figure VII-15 Future Housing Plans**




Note: n = 914 for plans to move; n = 393 for reasons for wanting to move.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

Among those who plan or want to move in the next three years, just over half (53%) wanted to move to find a different sized home or yard, followed by 46% who rent and wanted to own. About one third wanted to find more affordable housing and one quarter want to move to a different neighborhood.

**Barriers to moving.** A quarter (25%) of respondents wanted to move but are worried they will not be able to. The most selected barrier to moving was the inability to afford rents (57%), followed by inability to afford application fees or security deposits (31%), inability to afford other homes at current prices (31%), and bad or no credit history (19%).

Other open-ended responses included:

- "Affordable homes on a single salary cannot be found in my neighborhood." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "I can't save for a downpayment due to rising costs of everything." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "I grew up in Fort Collins and feel like I need to leave the state to afford to buy a house." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "Lack of affordable senior housing" – *Mobile Home Occupant in Fort Collins*

**Figure VII-16. Future Housing Plans and Barriers to Moving**

| I want to move to a home that better suits my needs but worried I won't be able to... | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | All Respondents 25% | | Fort Collins 26% | | Loveland 25% | | Elsewhere in Larimer County 20% | |
| **Barriers to Moving** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 57% | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 63% | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 57% | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 57% |
| 2 | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 31% | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 33% | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 32% | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 21% |
| 3 | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 31% | Other | 27% | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 31% | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 14% |
| 4 | Other | 23% | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 24% | I have bad or no credit history | 23% | None of the above | 7% |
| 5 | I have bad or no credit history | 19% | I have bad or no credit history | 17% | Other | 23% | I have a felony/criminal record and cannot find a place to rent | 7% |

Note: n = 914 for plans to move; n = 218 for barriers to moving.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Barriers to staying in home.** Nearly one out of every ten respondents (9%) said they want to stay in their current home but are worried they won't be able to do so. That proportion was higher in portions of the county outside Loveland and Fort Collins. Top reasons were housing cost increases and health concerns (e.g., aging, disability, etc.) and keeping up with maintenance. Those Elsewhere in County were more concerned about upkeep than respondents in other jurisdictions.

### Figure VII-17. Future Housing Plans and Barriers to Staying in Current Home

| | I want to move to a home that better suits my needs but worried I won't be able to... | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | All Respondents 25% | | Fort Collins 26% | | Loveland 25% | | Elsewhere in Larimer County 20% | |
| **Barriers to Moving** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 57% | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 63% | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 57% | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 57% |
| 2 | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 31% | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 33% | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 32% | I can't afford rents in other apartments/homes | 21% |
| 3 | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 31% | Other | 27% | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 31% | I can't afford application fees or security deposit | 14% |
| 4 | Other | 23% | Want to sell but can't afford to purchase something else | 24% | I have bad or no credit history | 23% | None of the above | 7% |
| 5 | I have bad or no credit history | 19% | I have bad or no credit history | 17% | Other | 23% | I have a felony/criminal record and cannot find a place to rent | 7% |

Note: n = 914 for plans to move; n = 218 for barriers to moving.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

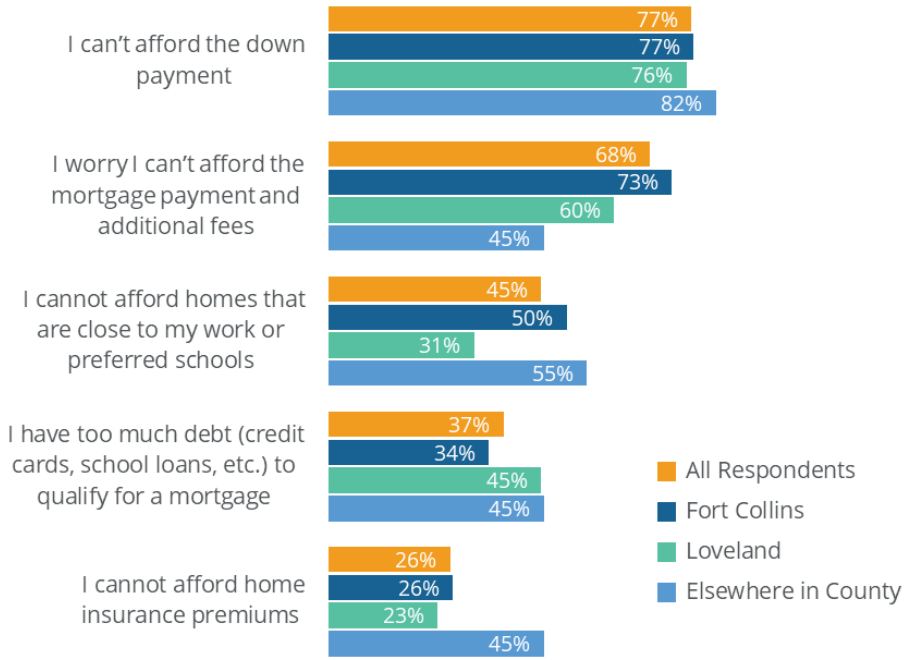
**Barriers to homeownership.** Renter respondents shared top barriers to homeownership in Larimer County. Seventy-seven percent of renters cited inability to pay the downpayment, followed by 68% who worry they can't afford mortgage payments or additional fees associated with homeownership, 45% cannot afford homes close to work or preferred schools, 37% have too much debt to qualify for a mortgage, and 26% cannot afford home insurance premiums.

Inability to afford a downpayment was the most frequent barrier in all jurisdictions. Respondents who live Elsewhere in Larimer County reported they cannot afford homes close to work or preferred schools (55%) and cannot afford home insurance premiums (45%) at the highest rates.

One potential avenue to affordable homeownership is deed restricted homeownership programs. These programs expand access to homeownership by reserving homes for households that cannot afford market rate prices. In exchange, resale is limited to income-eligible buyers, equity gains may be lower than market value, and homes are typically required to be owner-occupied.

Thirty-eight percent indicated they would be very interested and 31% said they would be interested in such a program. Only 11% reported they were not interested at all.

**Figure VII-18. Top Barriers to Home-ownership**



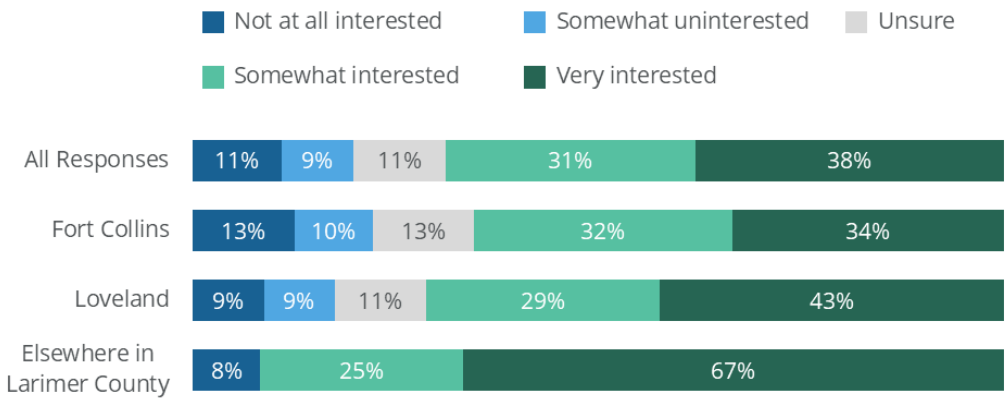

Note:

n = 265; Reflects renters only.

Source:

Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Figure VII-19. Interest in Deed-Restricted Homeownership Programs**




Note: n = 273; Reflects renters only.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

## WORK LOCATION AND COMMUTES

This survey evaluated the choices and patterns of commuters that work throughout Larimer County as well as in-commuters to Larimer County. Sixty-eight percent of respondents who are currently working live in the same community that they work. The choices of those who commute outside of their community are evaluated below.

Out of all commuters, only about one-third did *not* consider living in the same community as they work (when they were last looking for housing). Those respondents most commonly said it wasn't important to them to live where they work, they preferred a more rural environment, or have family or friends outside of the city in which they work. Affordability, accommodating a partner's commute, and schools were also top reasons. The diversity of answers shows that the choice of commuting is not a simple one—existing social networks, personal preference and amenities, and timing of job placement and home search are also factors.

**Figure VII-20. Percent of Commuters Who Did Not Consider Living in the Community They Work and Top Reasons**

| I did not consider living in the community where I work | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **All Commuters** 32% | | **In-Commuters to Fort Collins** 28% | | **In-Commuters to Loveland** 42% | | **In-Commuters to Elsewhere in Larimer County** 47% | |
| **Top Reasons for No Consideration** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | It's not important to me to live in the community I work | 44% | It's not important to me to live in Fort Collins | 42% | It's not important to me to live in Loveland | 53% | Other | 41% |
| 2 | Other | 35% | Other | 32% | Other | 32% | It's not important to me to live in the community I work | 35% |
| 3 | I prefer a more rural environment | 18% | I prefer a more rural environment | 26% | I have family or community outside of Loveland | 21% | I prefer a more rural environment | 12% |
| 4 | I have family or community outside of the community I work | 18% | I have family or community outside of Fort Collins | 26% | I prefer a more rural environment | 16% | I couldn't afford to live in the community I work | 12% |
| 5 | I couldn't afford to live in the community I work | 13% | Accommodate the commute of a household member | 21% | I chose schools outside of Loveland | 16% | Accommodate the commute of a household member | 12% |

Note: n = 764 for community consideration; n = 55 for reasons. Reflects respondents who live and work in different communities only.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

For respondents that *did* consider living in the same community that they work in, affordability was a primary factor in their decision to commute. Over half (57%) reported that the inability to find an affordable home to buy was a reason for them choosing a home outside of the community where they work. Respondents also reported that they had more buying power outside of the community they work in—31% said that housing that was affordable was lower quality and 29% said that housing that was affordable was too small. A quarter (25%) said that rents were unaffordable in the city that they work in.

**Figure VII-21.**
**Percent of Commuters Who Considered Living in the Community They Work and Top Reasons**

| | I considered living in the community where I work | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | All Commuters 68% | | In-Commuters to Fort Collins 72% | | In-Commuters to Loveland 58% | | In-Commuters to Elsewhere in Larimer County 53% | |
| **Top Reasons for Not Living in Same Community as Work** | | | | | | | | |
| 1 | I couldn't find an affordable home to buy | 57% | I couldn't find an affordable home to buy | 68% | I couldn't find an affordable apartment to rent | 42% | I couldn't find an affordable home to buy | 47% |
| 2 | Housing I could afford was lower quality | 31% | Housing I could afford was lower quality | 36% | I couldn't find an affordable home to buy | 42% | Other | 42% |
| 3 | Housing I could afford was too small | 29% | Housing I could afford was too small | 28% | Housing I could afford was too small | 35% | I couldn't find an affordable apartment to rent | 26% |
| 4 | I couldn't find an affordable apartment to rent | 25% | I couldn't find an affordable apartment to rent | 16% | Housing I could afford was lower quality | 31% | Housing I could afford was too small | 26% |
| 5 | Other | 22% | Other | 16% | Other | 19% | Housing I could afford was lower quality | 16% |

Note: n = 764 for community consideration; n = 95 for reasons. Reflects respondents who live and work in different communities only.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

***Open ended responses to "other" reasons in-commuters did not consider living in the community in which they work:***

- "Reduced shopping, activity and restaurant options." – *Commutes from Loveland to Elsewhere in Larimer County*
- "I love the community I live in but the job opportunity was elsewhere and I did not want to move for a job" – *Commutes from Fort Collins to Elsewhere in Larimer County*
- "I preferred living in Loveland over Greeley due to amenities and proximity to other cities." – *Commutes from Loveland to Greeley*
- "I don't like how un-diverse Loveland is. It's very conservative, older." – *Commutes from Fort Collins to Loveland*
- ""Too much traffic congestion in Fort Collins." – *Commutes from Loveland to Fort Collins*
- "I prefer to live in a more conservative city." – *Commutes from Loveland to Elsewhere in Larimer County*
- "Want to live in the mountains." – *Commutes from Loveland to Fort Collins*
- "Not the least bit interested in living in Weld County." – *Commutes from Loveland to Weld County*
- "I purchased my home before employment in Wellington." – *Commutes from Fort Collins to Elsewhere in Larimer County*

***Open ended responses to "other" reasons in-commuters did consider living in the community in which they work but opted to commute anyway:***

- "Berthoud did not have store in the community that I buy things at." – *Commutes from Loveland to Berthoud*
- "I could not afford to live in a safe neighborhood." – *Commutes from Fort Collins to Loveland*
- "All of my friends and extracurricular activities are in Fort Collins, so I wanted to be closer to Fort Collins. I had to move from Fort Collins because I couldn't afford to live there." – *Commutes from Loveland to Fort Collins*
- "Lack of available housing." – *Commutes from Unincorporated Larimer County to Fort Collins*
- "Low interest rate and new build neighborhood in Berthoud. I lived in Fort Collins 10 years and wanted a change." – *Commutes from Berthoud to Fort Collins*

## HOUSING SOLUTIONS AND POLICY INPUT

When asked about the importance of housing types serving various populations, survey respondents countywide rated "housing affordable to those in public service or retail jobs" received the highest rating, followed by "housing affordable to residents on a fixed income (like social security)," and then "starter homes."

Responses were similar in Fort Collins and Loveland, though Fort Collins residents placed a higher importance on supportive housing for people experiencing homelessness than respondents in other areas. Respondents living Elsewhere in Larimer County placed higher importance on homeownership: top ratings were starter homes and homes for middle class families.

**Figure VII-22. Rating of Importance of Housing Type in Community, Jurisdiction**

Note: n = 693.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

**Land use.** As shown in Figure VII-23, survey respondents were very open to "light density" housing products in their neighborhoods, including duplexes, townhomes, and accessory dwelling units (ADUs).

Allowing and adding more of these accepted product types can help create more natural affordability in existing neighborhoods as attached products typically have lower price points.

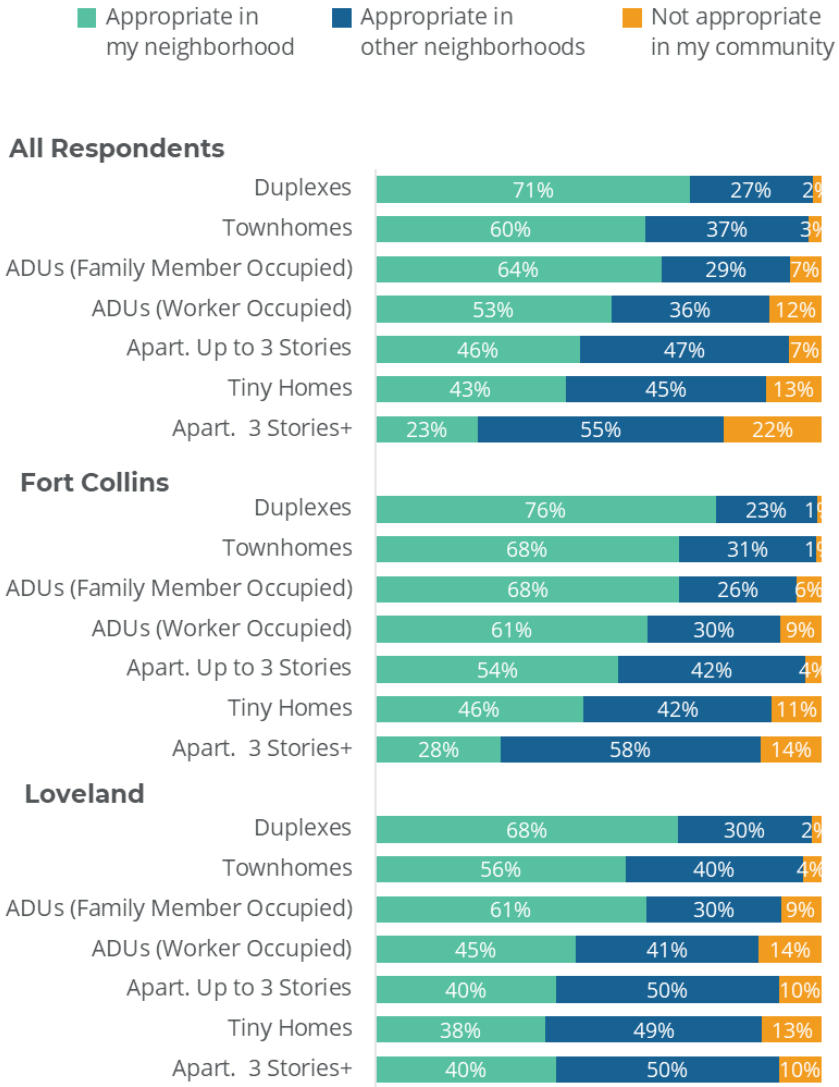
There was also relatively strong support for 3-story apartment buildings in respondents' communities, with the caveat that they are located at bus stops or major roads. This type of multifamily housing is an important product type to serve many of the households respondents want to accommodate (e.g., retail workers, residents on fixed incomes, etc.).

**Affordability tradeoffs.** Survey respondents were also asked about personal and community-oriented tradeoffs they would be willing to accept in order to make their communities more affordable.

- Sixty-percent said they would allow duplexes or townhomes to be built in their neighborhood (in line with previous housing type ratings) and 57% who would allow a small lot in their neighborhood.
- There was also support for requirements on developers making a portion of their developments affordable (59%).
- On financial tradeoffs, respondents were most open to higher property taxes on high value homes, but a majority (54%) also said they would pay $50 more per year in taxes to support an affordable housing fund.

Figure VII-24 on the following page shows these affordability tradeoffs by jurisdiction.

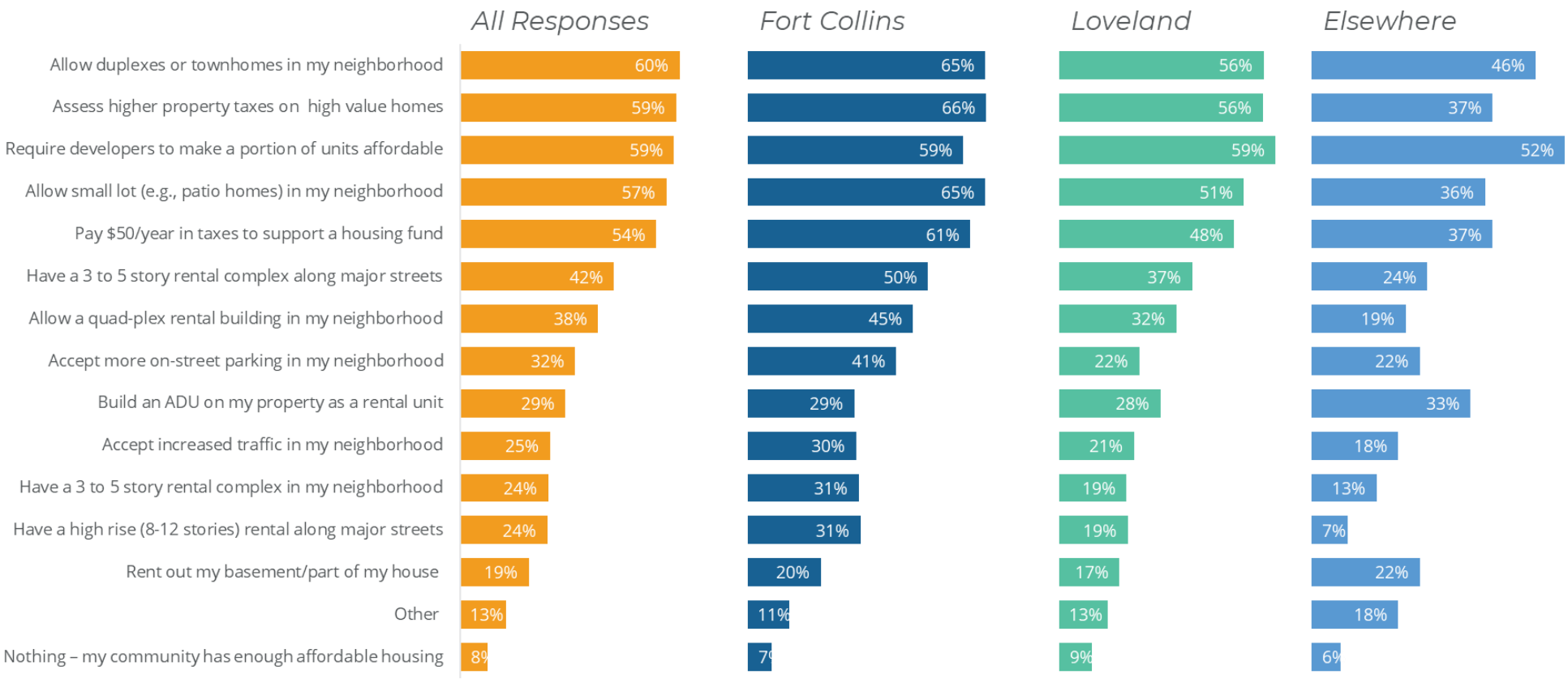
**Figure VII-23.**
**Appropriateness of Housing Type by Location**




Note: n = 273; Reflects renters only.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey

**Figure VII-24. Trade-Offs to Make Housing More Affordable in Community, by Jurisdiction**




Note: n = 839.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey.

Other open-ended responses by residents on tradeoffs included:

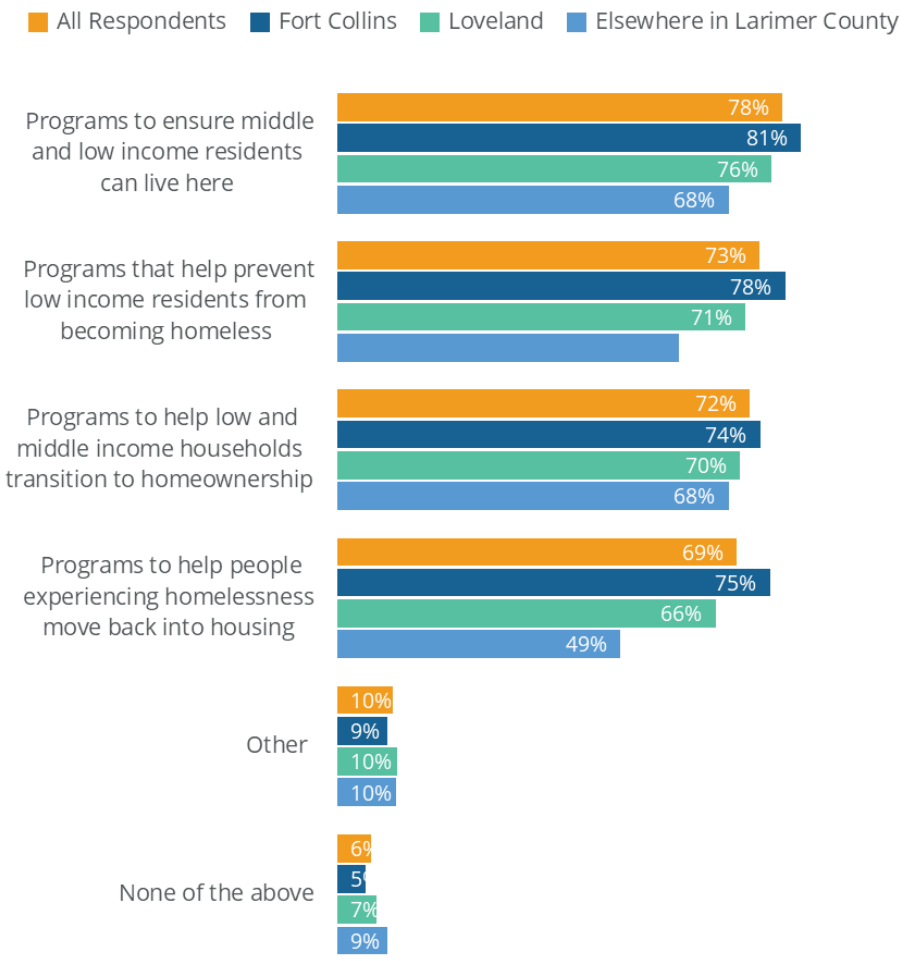
- "Build and allow short term rental small housing complex for seasonal workers and service providers (so that they will service our area)" – *Homeowner in Unincorporated Larimer County*
- "Promote tiny home villages with services (e.g. AA meetings, communal kitchens and showers)" – *Homeowner in Loveland*
- "Get rid of Metros and HOAs which drive up monthly costs. Get home owners insurance and interest rate down." – *Homeowner in Loveland*

**Program priorities.** When asked what types of programs respondents would like to see their local government invest in over the next five years, there was fairly broad support for a range of affordability programs. Very few respondents (less than 10% in all jurisdictions) said their local government should not invest in any of the specified program types. See Figure VII-25.

"Other" open-ended answers included:

- "Requirements for landlords to maintain high-quality homes (even in areas without an HOA). Landlords should care about their community and should not be allowed to charge high rent with no house improvements or care for maintaining the quality of the home." – *Homeowner in Fort Collins*
- "Senior citizen housing that is advertised and very affordable." – *Renter in Loveland*
- "Disabled citizens should be prioritized." – *Respondent in Loveland*
- "Change the zoning laws to encourage builders to build modest homes or more patio homes." – *Renter in Fort Collins*
- "No new programs -just fund the ones like Neighbor to Neighbor that are working well." – *Homeowner in Fort Collins*
- "Access to mental health services and education." – *Unincorporated Larimer County*

**Figure VII-25.**
**Which types of housing programs should your City and/or County invest in over the next five years?**




Note: n = 845.

Source: Root Policy Research from the 2025 Larimer County Resident Housing Survey